

Cutroom: Product Requirements

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Summary

Working name: Cutroom.

A rebuild of Higgsfield AI aimed at the solo creator and the small marketing team. Higgsfield competes on breadth: thirty plus models, dozens of one click apps, and a credit meter that ticks whether or not you got what you wanted. Cutroom takes the opposite bet.

The core belief is that the model is not the product. Frontier video models are commoditizing quickly, and Higgsfield itself is really an interface layer stacked on top of Sora, Kling, Veo and others. If the model is a commodity, then the product is everything around it: how you steer it, how it recovers when it is wrong, and how it feels to iterate. That is where taste lives, and that is what this rebuild competes on.

The soul of the product in one line: generation as editing, not gambling. You are never spending money into a black box and hoping. You are always steering, previewing cheaply, comparing takes, and committing once.

Who this is for

One user, chosen on purpose: the solo creator or small marketer who wants a great result fast and does not want to learn model names.

This is deliberately not built for the professional agency operator who wants deep manual control over every parameter and model. That user is real, and Higgsfield serves them, but trying to serve both through a single interface is a big part of why the current product feels heavy. Pro control is not deleted in Cutroom. It is demoted behind an advanced surface and kept out of the main flow.

Choosing one user is the decision that justifies most of the cuts in the scope section below.

What is wrong with the reference

Four frictions in Higgsfield that this rebuild sets out to fix:

1. **Choice paralysis.** A picker of thirty plus models, complete with version numbers, forces a decision the user has no basis to make.
2. **Gambling in the dark.** You spend credits, wait, and only then find out whether it worked. Both cost and outcome stay hidden until it is too late to change course.
3. **Feature sprawl.** A wall of apps and effects on the first screen buries the single thing a new user actually came to do.
4. **No real iteration or recovery.** When a result is close but wrong, or fails outright, the tool charges you and moves on. There is no cheap path from almost to right.

Product principles

Four principles. Every decision in this document traces back to one of them.

1. **The model is raw footage.** The product is the edit bay around it. Ship the workflow, not the model zoo.
2. **Never gamble in the dark.** Show cost before the click, preview cheaply, and commit only once.
3. **Recovery is a feature, not an error state.** Being wrong is the normal case in generation, so the path back to right belongs at the center of the product, not bolted on at the edge.
4. **Iteration should feel like play.** Exploring options should feel like a creative flow state, not like feeding a slot machine.

Scope: cut, change, add

A rebuild is a set of decisions about what to remove, what to rework, and what to introduce.

Decision	What	Why
Cut	The thirty plus model picker	Replaced by intent. The user says what they want and the app routes to the right model. Raw model choice moves behind an advanced toggle.
Cut	The wall of apps and effects on the home screen	Replaced by a searchable command palette plus three or four curated starting points.

Decision	What	Why
Change	One step generation becomes draft then render	A cheap fast draft first, approve the direction, then commit to the full render. This removes the credit gamble.
Change	Hidden cost becomes visible cost	Every action shows its cost before the click. The draft is free, the render costs a small amount.
Add	A variation grid with a branching history rail	From any take, spin variants, pick one, and jump back to any earlier good state.
Add	Prompt assist	Guided fields for subject, style, motion and mood, plus a surprise me option. Solves the blank page without feeling like a form.
Add	Error recovery with corrective nudges	Free instant reroll on failure, plus single tap fixes such as too fast or more cinematic, instead of rewriting the prompt.
Add	An editor style comparison surface	Takes live on a version rail rather than a wall of thumbnails, so iteration reads the way an editor thinks.

The core flow

This is the one flow built to production quality. Everything else in this document is scoped to protect it.

1. **Land.** A single calm screen: a prompt input, an intent selector, and a rail of recent takes if there are any. No model picker, no effects wall.
2. **Describe.** The user types a prompt, or uses prompt assist to fill in subject, style, motion and mood, then picks an intent such as a social short, a product ad, or a cinematic clip. Intent, not model, is the choice.
3. **Draft.** One click returns four rough previews, fast and free or nearly free, each showing its render cost as a small chip. This is the cheap look before any real spend.
4. **Pick a direction.** The user selects the draft that is heading the right way.

5. **Render.** Committing produces the full result. This is the only step that costs real credits, and the user arrives at it already knowing the direction is right.
6. **Remix and branch.** From any take, spin four variants or apply a corrective nudge. Every take is saved to a version rail, so the user branches from a good state instead of starting over.
7. **Recover.** If a generation fails, it rerolls for free and suggests what to try. If it is close but wrong, a nudge fixes it in one tap.

Feature requirements

Priorities are set for a twenty four hour build. P0 must ship. P1 ships if time allows. P2 is described in the writeup but not built.

Priority	Feature	Notes
P0	Draft then render pipeline	The spine of the product: cheap draft, then a committed render.
P0	Intent selector in place of model choice	The signature cut.
P0	Cost shown before every action	Chips on drafts and on the render button.
P0	Variation and branching on a version rail	The iteration loop.
P0	Error recovery: free reroll plus corrective nudges	The signature personal feature.
P1	Prompt assist with guided fields and a surprise me	Reduces the blank page problem.
P1	Command palette for apps and effects	The home screen replacement for sprawl.
P1	Keyboard shortcuts for navigating takes	An editor reflex that signals care.
P2	Advanced mode with raw model and parameter access	Serves the pro user without cluttering the core.
P2	Team sharing and collaboration	Out of scope for the build.

Priority	Feature	Notes
P2	A real model routing backend	The stub is designed to be swapped for this.

Out of scope

Deliberately not built, and named so the decision is visible to the reviewer:

- Real model inference. All generation is stubbed with placeholder media and simulated timing.
- Accounts, billing and real payments. Credits are a simulated number.
- Teams, sharing and collaboration.
- A native mobile app. The build is responsive web.
- The full apps and effects library. Only the command palette shell exists.

What great looks like

For this assignment, success is not fidelity to Higgsfield. Success is:

1. **The thesis is legible.** A reviewer can see within thirty seconds that this is generation reframed as editing, not a reskin of the original.
2. **One flow feels production grade.** The draft, render, remix and recover loop is smooth, fast and considered, down to its loading, empty and error states.
3. **The recovery and iteration loop is the memorable moment.** It is the clearest evidence of a real point of view.
4. **The writeup earns its place.** A short decisions document and a two minute walkthrough explain what was cut, what changed, and the lens behind the choices.